

DISTRICT SPECIAL · CHUSEOK D-9

## Only Eulji-ro's drink talk grew

### 01 Drink mentions on social media: six districts, 20 months

Seongsu -21%, Dosan -33%, Sindang -31%, Eulji-ro +18%

### 02 Chuseok D-9: six days left

To the last delivery before the break — the final order calendar

### 03 Orders pile onto the last delivery day before the break

Sewang shipments — week before 164, holiday week 45, week after 111

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**+18%**

Eulji-ro drink mentions  
adjusted change (Jan-Aug)

**41%**

Eulji-ro's share of drink  
mentions, six districts

**-33%**

Dosan · Apgujeong Rodeo  
steepest fall

**Editor's note** — Reading two months and calling it a rise is the common error in district reporting. We wrote one district up last month; **re-measured over all 20 months, it was the opposite.**



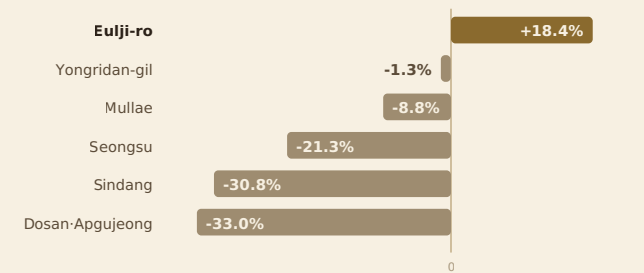
# Six districts, 20 months revisited

Seongsu, Eulji-ro, Dosan, Sindang, Yongridan-gil, Mullae. For the six Seoul districts people name for drinking, we counted how often each was **mentioned together with alcohol** on Instagram, from January 2025. **Only one grew.**

# Drink talk grew in one place only

Monthly counts of each district name posted with alcohol on Instagram, adjusted by ‘beer’ mentions (−4.5%).

JAN-AUG CHANGE · ADJUSTED BY BEER MENTIONS (%)



Five of the six fell. Only Eulji-ro rose, and it leads **on raw count** too: 8,686 mentions in Jan–Aug, nearly double Seongsu’s 4,490.

| District · share of mentions | 2025  | 2026  |
|------------------------------|-------|-------|
| Eulji-ro                     | 31.7% | 41.0% |
| Seongsu-dong · Seongsu Stn.  | 24.6% | 21.2% |
| Dosan · Apgujeong Rodeo      | 14.7% | 10.7% |
| Yongridan-gil · Sinyongsan   | 9.7%  | 10.5% |
| Sindang · Yaksu              | 10.9% | 8.3%  |
| Mullae                       | 8.4%  | 8.4%  |

IN ONE LINE

Four in ten drink mentions across the six districts are about **Eulji-ro** (six = 100). In one year, 9.3pp moved to one place.

Source: Sometrend Instagram monthly, district + alcohol, 2025.1–2026.8, Sep excluded. Rounded.

# Why Eulji-ro

We pulled the top 100 words that appear when Eulji-ro is named alongside drinking. The answer was not ‘hip’ alone.

## ALLEYS

### Hipjiro 677

Jongno 458

Chungmuro 228

Alley 155

## OUTDOOR SEATS

### Terrace 231

Show 220

Live 218

Rooftop 172

## OLD-SHOP DISHES

### Broth 310

Whelk 245

Squid 189

Chicken 186

The three clusters point one way: **alleys + outdoor seats + old-shop dishes**. That is exactly the yajang condition (street-front, outdoor seating) we covered last issue. Eulji-ro always had its beer alleys and street benches, and of the six districts we measured this year, only the one with that axis grew.

The list also carries **company dinner 204** and **new opening 179** — a sign that group bookings and new-venue enquiries are still live here. Frequency alone does not settle scale.

**This is not a call to move district.** Eulji-ro’s axis — alleys, outdoor seats, broth dishes — can be built in Seongsu or in Gangnam too. What this issue points to is not an address but an **axis**.

## FOR OPERATORS

① Alley feel, outdoor seats, old-shop dishes — **combine them to fit your venue**. ② Trial a beer/soju + broth-dish set on a small scale and watch turnover. ③ This Seollal, shipments recovered after the break. Prepare the **9/28 restart** against bookings and stock on hand.

Source: Sometrend Instagram top-100 associated keywords (Eulji-ro, 2026.7.1–9.11)

# Chuseok D-9: six days left

Chuseok falls on Friday 25 September; the break runs four days, 9/24–27. Sewang's last delivery before it is **Wed 9/23** — **six trading days** from 9/16, the day this report goes out.

| Date              | What to do                                       |
|-------------------|--------------------------------------------------|
| Wed 9/16 · today  | Fix holiday volumes · split out chilled items    |
| Thu 9/17–Fri 9/18 | Recommended first order cutoff                   |
| Sat 9/19–Sun 9/20 | Last weekend before the break · measure turnover |
| Mon 9/21          | <b>Final order cutoff · split delivery ①</b>     |
| Tue 9/22          | Split delivery ②                                 |
| Wed 9/23          | <b>Sewang's last pre-holiday delivery</b>        |
| 9/24–9/27         | Sewang closed · duty staff on call               |
| Mon 9/28          | <b>Sewang deliveries resume</b>                  |

## KEY ITEMS FIRST, THE REST IN SPLITS

**Build safety stock of key items by 9/21–22.** Do not take it all on the 9/23 final delivery — split the receipts. Book the 9/28 restart separately, and for draft kegs check your closing days, chilled storage and turnover.

Sewang Market Report skips the Chuseok week (Sep 23) and returns Wednesday Sep 30. Delivery dates around the October Foundation Day and Hangul Day holidays will be confirmed individually by your sales rep.



# This Seollal, shipments came back

This Seollal's shipment index: week before 164 · holiday week 45.  
**And the week after, 111.**

# Orders pile onto the last delivery day

Our own data this time, not someone else’s. We sorted, date by date, what Sewang accounts actually ordered (shipments) — restaurants and bars only, normal week = 100.

Last year’s Chuseok ran into two October holidays and stopped deliveries for **ten days**. This year it is **four**. So we set it beside **this year’s Seollal in February**, a five-day stop.

| Week               | Seollal · 5 days | Last Chuseok · 10 days |
|--------------------|------------------|------------------------|
| 2 weeks before     | 118              | —                      |
| <b>Week before</b> | <b>164</b>       | <b>169</b>             |
| Holiday week       | 45               | 43                     |
| <b>Week after</b>  | <b>111</b>       | <b>86</b>              |
| 2–3 weeks after    | 105–110          | 86–90                  |

SEOLLAL: ADVANCE BUYING, DEFERRED DEMAND

This Seollal showed less a drop in demand than **advance buying before the break and deferred demand after it**. One holiday’s pattern, though, cannot settle what this Chuseok will sell.

Seollal’s week-before shipments by weekday (same weekday = 100): **Mon 109 · Tue 149 · Wed 220 · Thu 170 · Fri 167**. The multiple peaked Wednesday; **absolute volume peaked Friday, the last delivery day**. This Chuseok that day is **Wed 9/23**. Build **safety stock of key items by 9/21–22**; take the rest in splits.

Source: Sewang shipments (restaurants & bars), 2025.9–12 · 2026.1–3, normal week = 100; weekday index vs. the same weekday. Shipments are not final consumption.

# Three questions: axis • order • after

## Q1 YOUR AXIS

What grew this year is not ‘polished’ but ‘alley’ — outdoor seats, broth dishes, beer and soju. Which side is your menu on?

## Q2 DID YOU SPLIT THE ORDER

This Seollal’s shipment index ran 164 the week before, 45 in the holiday week. Have you set safety stock of key items by 9/21–22, with the rest in split deliveries?

## Q3 THE WEEK AFTER

This Seollal showed advance buying and deferred demand after the break; the week-after index was 111. Have you prepared the 9/28–10/2 order against your bookings and stock?

| Item                       | 9/16–9/23          | 9/28–Oct |
|----------------------------|--------------------|----------|
| Beer • soju                | Increase           | Increase |
| Traditional • fruit liquor | Increase           | Hold     |
| Draft beer kegs            | Split around break | Increase |
| Whisky • spirits           | Hold               | Hold     |
| Sake • cheongju            | Hold               | Increase |
| Broth-dish stock           | Hold               | Increase |

Your sales rep will propose a mix sized to your venue and district.

# Yajang opened as forecast

Last issue we said the yajang season opens **from the second week of September**. Mentions rose from the August low of 703 to **1,205 in the first week of September, up 71%** — as forecast. The last two weeks are incomplete, so the beer-adjusted share returns next issue. The Golden Zone runs **to the last week of October**: six weeks.

## MOONLIGHT YAJANG: SIX DISTRICTS NAMED SEP 14

Seoul named its **first six Moonlight Yajang districts** on 14 September: Serosu-gil (Gangnam) · Konkuk Univ. food street (Gwangjin) · Sangbong food alley (Jungnang) · Sadang 1-dong food alley (Dongjak) · Sadang Orak (Gwanak) · Changdong Station shops (Dobong). 19 applied; **up to ₩2bn each**, 25 by 2028. The **outdoor-dining road-occupancy guideline** took effect the same day; the ordinance draft is due 21 September. Selection is no venue permit — check with your gu office.

## IF YOU HAVE NO OUTDOOR SEATING

① Trial the **beer/soju + broth-dish combination** and watch the orders; window seats and the menu carry the mood without outdoor tables. ② Outdoor seats: check weather, foot traffic, noise and cleanliness together. ③ **Inside a named district**, confirm zone and permits with the gu office first, then turnover, chilled storage and extra volume with your sales rep.

Source: Sometrend Instagram weekly 2026.6.22–9.11 / Moonlight Yajang selection, guideline: Kyunghyang · Financial News · Newspim, 2026.9.14. Venue eligibility: your gu office.

## NEXT ISSUE

**Next week (9/23) we skip for the Chuseok break.** Next issue Wed 9/30 — restart checklist and the six districts' opening prep.

# Owner, so this week do these three

Chuseok stock · yajang prep · the Eulji-ro combo. Three action points you can check on the floor today.

## 01 CHUSEOK STOCK

### Safety stock of key items by 9/21–22

Sewang's last pre-holiday delivery is Wed 9/23. Split receipts so nothing piles onto the final day, and prepare the 9/28 restart separately against bookings and stock on hand.

## 02 YAJANG PREP

### Check the operating rules before adding seats

Confirm the zone, road-occupancy and outdoor-dining requirements with your gu office. Within what is allowed, check weather, foot traffic, noise and cleanliness, and get beer and broth-dish turnover ready.

## 03 THE EULJI-RO COMBO

### Alley + outdoor seats + old-shop dishes + drink

Trial the beer/soju and broth or old-shop dish combination that fits your venue. No outdoor seats? Use window seats and the room's mood, and adjust to actual orders.

Ask your **sales rep** for venue-level order volumes and split deliveries. Contacts are on the next page.

# A partner that grows alongside you

From Chuseok volumes to the restart in the first week back and urgent stock during the break, your sales rep will advise you to suit your venue. Founded in 1978, Sewang Trading has served Seoul and Gyeonggi as a full-line liquor wholesaler for nearly half a century.

|                                                                               |               |
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| <b>Park Jung-eon</b> Exec. Dir.                                               | 010-3286-9489 |
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| <b>Son Seung-il</b> Man. Dir.                                                 | 010-7539-3535 |
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| Hotels · wine                                                                 |               |
| <b>Kim Hwan</b> Director                                                      | 010-4789-3282 |
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| New account development                                                       |               |

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